

FILM REVIEW

ROCKET SINGH: SALESMAN OF THE YEAR

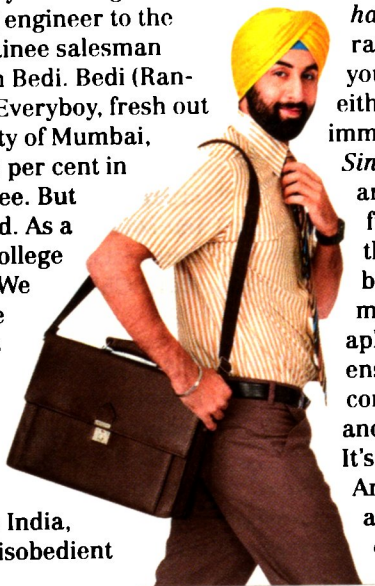
Pitched Right

RATING ★ ★ ★ ★ ☆

Director: Shimit Amin

Starring: Ranbir Kapoor

Ande se nikle nahin, butter chicken *banne chale*, says the disgusted porn-watching engineer to the bright-eyed trainee salesman Harpreet Singh Bedi. Bedi (Ranbir Kapoor) is Everyboy, fresh out of the University of Mumbai, with just 38.72 per cent in his BCom degree. But he's undeterred. As a slogan at the college farewell says: We passed, college failed. Bedi, as played by Kapoor with a sweet insouciance, could be any young man in middle India, occasionally disobedient



to his *Ramayan*-watching grandfather, a little too honest with his bosses, and ever loyal to his friends. He believes business is all about people, not numbers. He thinks one doesn't need either chicanery or thuggery to get ahead in the cubicle war and what he absolutely abhors is anyone underestimating him. "Only mice are nice," he says, shrugging off the "joker Sardar" tag. He's determined to do well because "*number kam hain, dimag nahin*". It's rare for a movie to get young people right. They either infantilise them or immortalise them. *Rocket Singh* shows them as they are: in the throes of their first jobs, first loves, and the first hard knocks in a big bad world. The movie is more than the sum of its aphorisms, its note-perfect ensemble cast, mostly comprising theatre actors, and its post-it perfect office. It's not showy but it is serene. And yes, Kapoor is one egg all set to become a butter chicken. **by Kaveree Bamzai**

ART EXHIBITION

A Colourful MIX

Curated by Murali Cheerth, Evidentia is a group show featuring 16 artists in a variety of mediums. At Gallery Sumukha, Bangalore, from December 19.



IDENTICAL FATE

Priti Vadakkath Titled *Identical Fate*, her work features a continuous engagement with the environment using water colours. Cut trees and smiling girls are used as metaphors.

Bhagyanath C. His oil on canvas uses magic realism to create a fantastic genre with a variety of incidents and imaginations being represented in a layered space and time.

SPACE AND LADDERS



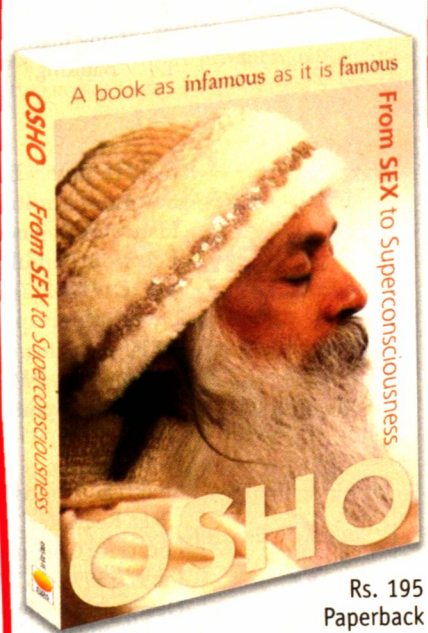
KASHI'S UNTITLED WORK

Ravikumar Kashi His untitled work is a signature Kashi mimicking the pop "art"-ish nature of realism, featuring a free leap across resplendent blue skies in acrylic and oil. **by Nirmala Ravindran**

... And the route is simple:

SEX

just has to be part of your religious life, it has to be something sacred...



OSHO

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